

How is AI 'bad' for the environment?

Posted by u/DarkCryptt • 0 points • 2 comments

I've heard a lot that AI is bad for the environment because it wastes water and causes more CO₂ emissions, but can anyone tell me how?

Comments

u/Super_Walk3492 • 3 points • 2025-10-21 19:09 UTC

<https://www.technologyreview.com/2025/05/20/1116327/ai-energy-usage-climate-footprint-big-tech/>

TL;DR: AI generation uses huge amounts of power and water because the chips that power AI require it. The individual chips may be energy efficient but they are using hundreds of thousands, soon millions, of them at once to satisfy demand.

u/bangbangracer • 5 points • 2025-10-21 19:08 UTC

Power and water consumption. It's that simple. This is brought up nearly every day. It converts tons of clean potable water into grey waste water that needs to be processed before going back into the reservoirs, and AI server farms use a fuck ton of electricity. And by fuck ton, I mean putting solar panels on the roof is a drop in a bucket of their consumption. There are talks of needing nuclear facilities on-site for power production.